

Word family: **entrench / entrenches / entrenched / entrenching / entrenchment**

Base word: entrench

Past tense: entrenched

Past participle: entrenched

** -ing form:** entrenching

Major related forms:

* entrenched

* entrenchment

Variant spelling:

* **intrench / intrenched / intrenchment** — genuine but much less common variant; **entrench** is the form learners should prioritize. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

Important constructions/extensions:

* deeply / firmly entrenched

* entrenched attitude / belief / habit

* entrenched practice / system

* entrenched interests

* entrenched inequality / poverty / disadvantage

* entrenched problem

* entrench power / control / advantage

* entrench oneself

* entrench oneself in office/a position

* entrenched position

* entrench rights / protections

* entrenched provision

* constitutional entrenchment

* provision for entrenchment

* managerial entrenchment

* linguistic entrenchment

* channel/river entrenchment

* entrenched meander

* entrench on/upon — archaic/rare

* entrenching tool

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Related noun/adjective: entrenchment (名詞) , entrenched (形容詞 / 分詞)

Your sentence:

> “...it relieves pressure for a few individuals but **entrenches the larger structural problem** for

everyone else.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **entrench** means **to make an existing problem, system, or pattern become more firmly established and therefore more difficult to change or solve**.

The writer's point is that allowing tutoring to spill into restaurants may temporarily help individual students, but it reduces the pressure to create proper study facilities. As a result, the underlying shortage of suitable study space may become **more permanent and harder to fix**.

繁體中文：

* **使.....根深蒂固**

* **使.....固化**

* **使.....更加牢固而難以改變**

* **對問題而言可譯作 令問題長期化 / 固化**

A natural translation is:

> “...but **entrenches** the larger structural problem for everyone else.”

「.....但卻會令更大的結構性問題變得**根深蒂固、更難解決**。」

The key nuance is not merely:

> **make the problem worse**.

Rather:

> **make the problem more firmly built into the existing system, so that changing it later becomes harder.**

A. LITERAL MILITARY SENSE — FORTIFY WITH TRENCHES

1. **entrench** = surround/protect a position by digging trenches (築壕防守) — 築壕；以壕溝加固

This is the original literal military sense.

Practice 1

> “The soldiers **entrenched** their position.”

「士兵挖掘壕溝，**加固了陣地**。」

Practice 2

> “The troops became heavily **entrenched**.”

「部隊築起大量壕溝，形成了堅固的**防禦陣地**。」

Literally:

> trenches are dug around/within a position so it becomes harder to attack.

Modern figurative **entrench** develops directly from this image:

> hard to remove militarily → hard to change socially/intellectually.

The literal trench sense remains dictionary-established. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

2. **entrench oneself = dig into a defensive position (掘壕固守) **

Practice 3

> “The troops entrenched themselves on the hillside.”

「部隊在山坡上**掘壕固守**。」

Literal construction:

> **entrench oneself + location**

3. **entrenched position = fortified military position (築壕防守的陣地) **

Practice 4

> “The attackers struggled to dislodge the defenders from their entrenched positions.”

「進攻者很難把守軍逐出其**堅固的壕溝防禦陣地**。」

This phrase later develops a very common figurative meaning:

> firmly held opinion/stance.

4. **entrenched troops / forces = stationed behind prepared defensive works**

> “Entrenched forces resisted the advance.”

「**築壕固守的部隊**抵抗了推進。」

5. **entrenched camp = fortified camp (築壕營地 / 設防營地) **

Historical/military terminology.

A camp protected by defensive earthworks/trenches.

Priority: specialist/historical.

B. **ENTRENCHMENT — MILITARY FORTIFICATION**

6. **entrenchment = act/process of fortifying with trenches (築壕) **

> “The army began the entrenchment of the position.”

「軍隊開始為陣地**築壕設防**。」

7. **an entrenchment = defensive trench/fortification (壕溝防禦工事) **

Historically, **entrenchment** can also refer to:

> the actual defensive works.

So it can be countable:

> defensive entrenchments

= **防禦壕溝 / 工事**

8. **field entrenchments = 野戰壕溝工事**

Temporary defensive earthworks constructed in the field.

C. **ENTRENCHING TOOL**

9. **entrenching tool = military digging tool (掘壕工具)**

Usually a compact shovel/spade used for digging:

- * trenches
- * foxholes
- * defensive positions

Often called informally:

> **E-tool**

****繁體中文：***軍用掘壕鏟 / 掘壕工具****

This is an established compound, not a separate meaning of the verb.

D. FIGURATIVE CORE — MAKE SOMETHING FIRMLY ESTABLISHED

10. **entrench something = make it firmly established and difficult to change (使根深蒂固)**

This is by far the most important modern figurative sense.

Practice 5

> “The arrangement could **entrench** existing problems.”

「這種安排可能令現有問題變得更加**根深蒂固**。」

Practice 6

> “Repeated exceptions may entrench the practice.”

「一再作出例外安排，可能會令這種做法逐漸**固定下來、難以改變**。」

The metaphor is:

> an idea/system becomes as difficult to remove as soldiers protected inside trenches.

Modern dictionaries characterize this figurative sense as making power, customs, ideas, etc. firmly established and difficult to change. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

E. **ENTRENCHED = DEEPLY ESTABLISHED**

11. **entrenched = firmly established over time (根深蒂固的)**

The adjective/participle is extremely common—often more common in practice than active **entrench**.

Practice 7

> “The habit is deeply **entrenched**.”

「這種習慣已經**根深蒂固**。」

Practice 8

> “Changing such entrenched practices will take time.”

「改變這些**根深蒂固的做法**需要時間。」

Common intensifiers:

- * deeply entrenched
- * firmly entrenched
- * well entrenched
- * strongly entrenched
- * long-entrenched

12. **deeply entrenched = extremely firmly established (根深蒂固)**

Practice 9

> “The belief is deeply entrenched.”

「這種信念已經**根深蒂固**。」

One of the word family's highest-value collocations.

13. **firmly entrenched = securely established (牢固確立) **

> “The practice became firmly entrenched.”

「這種做法逐漸變得**牢固而難以改變**。」

F. ENTRENCHED BELIEFS / ATTITUDES

14. **entrenched belief = deeply established belief (根深蒂固的信念) **

Practice 10

> “Evidence alone may not change an entrenched belief.”

「單靠證據未必能改變**根深蒂固的信念**。」

15. **entrenched attitude = difficult-to-change attitude (根深蒂固的態度) **

> “The programme aims to challenge entrenched attitudes.”

「這個計劃旨在挑戰一些**根深蒂固的態度**。」

16. **entrenched prejudice/bias = deeply established prejudice/bias (根深蒂固的偏見) **

The word emphasizes:

> persistence and resistance to change,

not necessarily how the belief originally arose.

17. **entrenched assumption = assumption treated as established truth (根深蒂固的假設) **

Academic/business usage:

> assumptions become entrenched and stop being questioned.

18. **entrenched mindset = 固化思維 / 根深蒂固的思維模式**

A common modern collocation.

G. HABITS / CUSTOMS / PRACTICES

19. **entrenched habit = long-established habit difficult to break (根深蒂固的習慣) **

> “It is difficult to change entrenched habits.”

「要改變**根深蒂固的習慣**並不容易。」

20. **entrenched custom/tradition = firmly established custom (牢固形成的傳統) **

The term itself is neutral about whether the tradition is good or bad.

21. **entrenched practice = established institutional/social practice (根深蒂固的做法) **

Especially common in:

* workplaces

* institutions

* industries

* social systems

22. **entrench a practice = cause it to become normalized and hard to remove**

Practice 11

> “Temporary measures can sometimes entrench inefficient practices.”

「臨時措施有時反而會令低效率的做法**固化**。」

H. SYSTEMS / INSTITUTIONS

23. **entrench a system = make a system harder to reform or replace (鞏固 / 固化制度) **

> “The arrangement entrenched the existing system.”

「這項安排進一步**固化了現有制度**。」

This can be neutral, positive, or negative depending on what is being entrenched.

24. **entrenched institution = long-established institution resistant to change**

> 「根深蒂固 / 牢固確立的制度或機構」

25. **institutional entrenchment = institutional arrangements becoming difficult to alter (制度固化) **

Academic/social-science extension.

Can involve:

- * routines
- * norms
- * incentives
- * formal rules
- * power structures

This is generally a domain application of the figurative core, not a completely separate dictionary sense.

26. **entrench bureaucracy = make bureaucratic structures/processes harder to change**

> 「使官僚體制進一步固化」

Again, **entrench** emphasizes durability, not merely growth.

I. PROBLEMS / DISADVANTAGE

27. **entrench a problem = make the problem persistent and harder to solve (令問題固化) **

This is the **exact passage branch**.

Practice 12 — Passage sense

> “The temporary solution may **entrench** the underlying problem.”

「這個臨時辦法可能反而令根本問題變得**根深蒂固、更難解決**。」

28. **entrenched problem** = persistent structural problem (根深蒂固的問題)

> “Short-term fixes will not solve an entrenched problem.”

「短期補救措施無法解決一個**根深蒂固的問題**。」

29. **entrench disadvantage** = make disadvantage persistent (使弱勢狀況固化)

> “Poor access to education can entrench disadvantage.”

「教育機會不足可能令弱勢狀況**長期固化**。」

30. **entrench inequality** = make inequality more persistent (使不平等固化)

Common social/economic usage.

The word does not merely mean:

> increase inequality numerically.

It means:

> make the unequal pattern more structurally persistent.

31. **entrenched inequality** = structural/persistent inequality (根深蒂固的不平等)

32. **entrench poverty** = make poverty harder to escape (使貧困長期化 / 固化)

> “The policy may unintentionally entrench poverty.”

「這項措施可能無意中令貧困問題**長期化**。」

33. **entrenched poverty = long-standing persistent poverty (長期根深蒂固的貧困) **

34. **entrench exclusion / marginalization = make exclusion structurally persistent**

Formal social-science usage.

J. POWER / CONTROL

35. **entrench power = make someone's/institution's power secure and hard to challenge (鞏固權力) **

Practice 13

> “The new structure could entrench the leadership's control.”

「新的架構可能進一步**鞏固管理層的控制權**。」

The core is:

> make power harder to remove/challenge.

36. **entrenched power = securely established power (牢固的權力結構) **

37. **entrench control = 固化 / 鞏固控制權**

38. **entrench authority = make authority more securely established**

Can be neutral depending on context.

39. **entrench oneself in power = make one's own position difficult to remove**

> “The leader entrenched himself in power.”

Lexically:

「該領導者令自己的權力地位變得**十分穩固、難以動搖**。」

The construction focuses on security/permanence of position.

K. **ENTRENCH ONESELF**

40. **entrench oneself = establish oneself securely in a position (站穩陣腳)**

Beyond literal military use:

Practice 14

> “The company quickly entrenched itself in the market.”

「公司很快便在市場上**站穩陣腳**。」

Meaning:

> establish a strong position that competitors find difficult to dislodge.

41. **entrench oneself in a job/post/office = secure one's position**

> “He had become deeply entrenched in the organization.”

「他在該機構內的地位已經非常**穩固**。」

42. **entrench oneself within an institution = become securely embedded**

Formal.

L. BUSINESS / MARKET POSITION

43. **entrenched competitor = long-established competitor with a strong position (根基穩固的競爭者) **

> “New entrants must compete with entrenched firms.”

「新進者必須與市場地位**根深蒂固 / 非常穩固**的公司競爭。」

44. **entrenched incumbent = existing provider/person with a strongly protected position**

Common in:

* business

* technology

* institutions

incumbent already means the existing holder/provider; **entrenched** adds:

> difficult to displace.

45. **entrenched market position = 難以撼動的市場地位**

46. **entrench competitive advantage = make an advantage durable (鞏固競爭優勢) **

Business-strategy usage.

Compare:

> gain an advantage

> entrench an advantage

The second means:

> make it harder for competitors to remove.

47. **entrenched brand/product = strongly established in consumers' habits/market**

A compositional commercial application.

M. ****ENTRENCHED INTERESTS****

48. ****entrenched interests = powerful established interests resistant to change (根深蒂固的既得利益)****

A highly important expression.

It typically refers to:

> people/groups/organizations whose established advantages give them reason and ability to resist change.

****繁體中文 : ****

* ****根深蒂固的既得利益****

* ****勢力穩固的利益集團**** depending on context

49. ****vested interests vs entrenched interests****

****vested interests****

people/groups have a personal stake in maintaining something.

****entrenched interests****

those interests are additionally ****well established and difficult to dislodge****.

They overlap, but are not identical.

N. POSITION / OPINION

50. ****entrenched position = strongly held stance that someone resists changing (固守的立場)****

Practice 15

> “Both sides remained in entrenched positions.”

「雙方仍然****固守原有立場****。」

This metaphor comes directly from military defensive positions.

51. **become entrenched in one's position/view = increasingly unwilling to compromise**

> “The longer the dispute continued, the more entrenched their positions became.”

「爭議拖得越久，雙方立場越來越**僵化 / 難以改變**。」

52. **entrenched opposition = firmly established resistance (根深蒂固的反對) **

53. **entrenched view/opinion = strongly fixed view (根深蒂固的觀點) **

O. TECHNOLOGY / STANDARDS

54. **entrenched technology/system = technology so widely established that replacement is difficult**

Example:

> “The old format remains deeply entrenched.”

「舊格式仍然**根深蒂固 / 廣泛使用而難以取代**。」

Possible causes:

- * installed base
- * compatibility
- * training
- * switching costs
- * network effects

These are contextual explanations, not built into the verb itself.

55. **entrenched standard = widely established standard hard to replace**

Formal technology/business application.

56. ****entrenched legacy system = long-established older system difficult to replace****

Common business/IT phrasing.

This remains the ordinary figurative branch.

P. LAW / CONSTITUTIONAL LAW

57. ****entrench a right/rule/protection = give it stronger protection against ordinary alteration (使權利 / 規則受較強保障) ****

Unlike many negative examples, this can be ****positive or neutral****.

Practice 16

> “The constitution entrenches certain rights.”

Lexically:

「憲制安排對某些權利給予****較難被普通程序改變的保障****。」

The exact legal mechanism depends on the jurisdiction.

58. ****constitutional entrenchment = making constitutional norms harder to amend than ordinary law (憲法 / 憲制上的剛性保障) ****

In constitutional theory, ****entrenchment**** broadly means that changing the relevant constitutional norm requires more than the ordinary lawmaking process or is otherwise made more difficult. ([劍橋大學出版社][2])

****繁體中文可譯：****

* ****憲法上的剛性保障****

* ****憲制條文的強化保障****

* ****憲制固化 / 鎖定**** depending on context

No single Chinese rendering works perfectly in every legal system.

59. ****entrenched provision = provision subject to stronger amendment restrictions (受特別保障的條文)****

Meaning:

> it cannot be amended as easily as an ordinary provision.

60. ****entrenchment clause / entrenching clause = clause making another rule harder to change****

Specialist constitutional/company-law vocabulary.

61. ****entrench rights = protect rights from easy repeal/amendment****

Important distinction:

Here ****entrench**** does not mean something bad becomes stubborn.

It means:

> deliberately give something institutional durability.

62. ****entrench a constitutional principle****

= place the principle beyond ordinary/easy alteration.

P2. COMPANY LAW — ****PROVISION FOR ENTRENCHMENT****

63. ****provision for entrenchment = rule making specified constitutional/company provisions harder to amend****

For example, UK company law expressly uses ****“provision for entrenchment”**** for articles that impose amendment/repeal conditions more restrictive than an ordinary special-resolution route.
([英國立法][3])

****繁體中文：可按法律文本譯作 加強修訂限制的條款 / 固化條款 / 特別修訂限制****

This is highly specialist and jurisdiction-dependent.

64. ****entrenched articles/provisions — company constitution****

A corporate governing document can contain provisions subject to enhanced restrictions on amendment.

Again, the exact legal effect depends on applicable company law.

Q. CORPORATE GOVERNANCE — MANAGERIAL ENTRENCHMENT

65. ****managerial entrenchment = managers becoming difficult for owners/boards to replace (管理層固守地位)****

A major corporate-governance term.

In corporate-finance literature, ****managerial entrenchment**** concerns managers becoming insulated from normal replacement or governance discipline, for example because replacing them has become costly or difficult. ([科學直接網站][4])

****繁體中文 : ****

*** **管理層固守****

*** **管理層地位固化****

*** **管理層鞏固自身地位****

66. ****entrenched management = management difficult to remove****

> 「地位十分穩固、難以撤換的管理層」

This is not simply:

> experienced management.

It specifically implies resistance to displacement/accountability mechanisms.

67. ****management entrenchment hypothesis****

An established corporate-governance/finance research concept concerning incentives/effects

when management can insulate itself from removal. ([科學直接網站][4])

68. **entrenchment index / E-index**

Corporate-governance research uses measures intended to quantify features associated with managerial/shareholder-rights entrenchment; one established literature refers to an **entrenchment index (E-index)** ([科學直接網站][5])

Priority: specialist finance/governance.

R. ORGANIZATIONAL ENTRENCHMENT

69. **entrenched management structure / hierarchy = structure resistant to organizational change**

> 「固化的管理架構 / 層級制度」

70. **entrenched organizational culture = deeply established culture**

A general organizational-behaviour application.

71. **entrench a process = make a process become the default and difficult to replace**

Can be deliberate:

> formalizing a workflow entrenches it.

or unintended:

> temporary workarounds become entrenched.

S. LANGUAGE / COGNITIVE LINGUISTICS

72. **entrenchment = strengthening of a linguistic representation through repeated experience/use (語言形式的認知固化) **

A genuine technical sense in usage-based/cognitive linguistics.

Repeated exposure/use can cause linguistic units or constructions to become increasingly strongly represented or **entrenched** in memory. ([劍橋大學出版社][6])

Possible Traditional Chinese:

* **固化** *

* **固著** *

* **認知鞏固** *

* **語言形式的固化程度** *

Terminology varies by academic tradition.

73. **linguistic entrenchment = 語言結構的固化 / 認知鞏固**

Relevant to:

* words

* collocations

* grammatical constructions

* morphological patterns

Frequency is often discussed as one contributor, though the relationship is not reducible to a single simple frequency measure. ([劍橋大學出版社][7])

74. **a construction becomes entrenched**

> repeated usage causes it to become an established mental linguistic pattern.

This is technical, not social “stubbornness.”

T. GEOMORPHOLOGY / GEOLOGY

75. **entrench = cut downward into a surface through erosion (下切成深槽)**

A real specialist physical sense:

> a river/channel **entrenches** itself into a valley or sediment.

Dictionary sources also record the geological sense of erosion cutting downward to form a trough/trench. ([柯林斯詞典][8])

76. **river/channel entrenchment = river channel becomes deeply incised (河道下切 / 深切) **

Practice 17

> “The river became deeply entrenched below its former floodplain.”

「河道向下侵蝕，形成了明顯的**深切河槽**。」

USGS usage describes river **entrenchment** involving channel deepening below the former floodplain. ([美國地質調查局][9])

77. **entrenched channel = deeply incised channel (深切河道) **

The river sits considerably below the surrounding valley/floodplain surface.

78. **entrenched river = 下切河流 / 深切河道**

Geomorphology sense, not metaphorical.

79. **entrenched meander = deeply incised meander (深切曲流) **

A specialist geomorphology term for a meandering river form cut deeply into its valley/bedrock setting. USGS literature distinguishes entrenched meanders from other incised-meander forms. ([USGS Publications][10])

繁體中文： **深切曲流 / 嵌入曲流** depending on textbook terminology.

80. **channel entrenchment**

Used in river/stream morphology for the extent to which a channel has become vertically confined/deep relative to its surrounding floodplain/valley.

Priority: specialist environmental/geomorphological use.

U. FIGURATIVE PHYSICAL POSITION

81. **entrenched behind something = securely protected by it**

Can be literal:

> troops entrenched behind fortifications.

Or figurative:

> “They remained entrenched behind procedural rules.”

「他們以程序規則作為屏障，**固守立場**。」

82. **entrenched in = deeply embedded in a system/place**

Practice 18

> “The practice is entrenched in the organization.”

「這種做法在該機構內已經**根深蒂固**。」

This is perhaps the highest-value prepositional construction.

83. **entrenched within = firmly embedded within**

> “The problem is entrenched within the system.”

「問題已經**深深植根於制度之中**。」

Slightly more formal than **in**.

84. **entrenched as + role/status**

> “The company became entrenched as the market leader.”

「公司作為市場領導者的地位變得非常**穩固**。」

Possible but less central than **entrenched in**.

V. RARE / ARCHAIC: **ENTRENCH ON / UPON**

85. **entrench on/upon = encroach on; infringe (侵佔 ; 侵犯)**

This is a genuine but now rare/archaic intransitive sense.

Example:

> “to entrench upon another's rights”

= 「**侵犯**他人的權利」

Modern English would normally use:

* encroach on

* infringe on/upon

Dictionaries still record this older sense. ([柯林斯詞典][1])

Database priority: low, but include under fullest coverage.

W. **INTRench** VARIANT

86. **intrench = variant spelling of entrench**

Older/less common.

Forms:

* intrench

* intrenched

* intrenching

* intrenchment

Modern learner default:

> **entrench**

X. ENTRENCHMENT = FIGURATIVE STATE/PROCESS

87. **entrenchment = process of becoming firmly established (固化 ; 根深蒂固化) **

Practice 19

> “The policy contributed to the entrenchment of the existing system.”

「這項政策促使現有制度進一步**固化**。」

88. **entrenchment of inequality/problem/practice**

Common abstract structure:

> **the entrenchment of X**

= X becomes increasingly difficult to change.

Examples:

- * entrenchment of inequality
- * entrenchment of disadvantage
- * entrenchment of particular practices

89. **deepening entrenchment = increasing resistance to change**

> “The dispute led to further entrenchment.”

「爭議令雙方的立場更加**僵化 / 固化**。」

Y. HIGH-VALUE COLLOCATIONS

Things that can be **entrenched**

Ideas

- * belief
- * attitude
- * prejudice

- * assumption
- * mindset
- * opinion

Behaviour

- * habit
- * custom
- * practice
- * routine

Systems

- * institution
- * bureaucracy
- * hierarchy
- * process
- * structure
- * status quo

Problems

- * inequality
- * disadvantage
- * poverty
- * exclusion
- * structural problem

Position/power

- * authority
- * control
- * power
- * market position
- * advantage
- * interests

Legal

- * right
- * protection
- * rule
- * provision
- * constitutional principle

90. ****become entrenched****

Very common:

> “The practice gradually became entrenched.”

「這種做法逐漸變得****根深蒂固****。」

This often suggests:

> repeated use over time → difficult to reverse.

91. ****remain entrenched****

> “The problem remains deeply entrenched.”

「這個問題依然****根深蒂固****。」

92. ****increasingly entrenched****

> “Their positions became increasingly entrenched.”

「雙方的立場越來越****僵化 / 固守不變****。」

93. ****well-entrenched****

> “a well-entrenched competitor”

= ****市場根基穩固、難以撼動的競爭者****

Usually hyphenated before a noun.

94. ****long-entrenched****

> a long-entrenched practice

= ****長久以來根深蒂固的做法****

Z. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

entrench vs establish

establish

= cause something to begin and become recognized/stable.

entrench

= make it **especially difficult to remove or change**.

> establish a practice

> entrench a practice

The second implies much greater resistance to reversal.

entrench vs reinforce

reinforce

= strengthen something.

entrench

= strengthen it particularly in terms of **persistence and resistance to change**.

A stereotype may be reinforced once.

Repeated reinforcement may eventually entrench it.

entrench vs perpetuate

Very relevant to your passage.

perpetuate

= cause something to continue.

entrench

= cause it not only to continue, but to become **more deeply built in and harder to change**.

> perpetuate a problem

> = keep it going.

> entrench a problem

> = make it structurally harder to solve.

Entrench is stronger.

entrench vs exacerbate

exacerbate

= make a problem more severe.

entrench

= make a problem more persistent/harder to remove.

A policy can:

* exacerbate a problem without making it permanent;

* entrench a problem without immediately making its numerical severity much greater.

This is a crucial distinction.

entrench vs worsen

worsen

= become/make worse generally.

entrench

= make resistant to change.

So your passage is not simply saying restaurant tutoring **worsens** the space shortage.

It says it may make the bad structure **persist**.

****entrench vs deepen****

****deepen a problem****

often means intensify it.

****entrench a problem****

means make it more firmly embedded.

They often co-occur but are conceptually distinct.

****entrench vs embed****

****embed****

= place/fix something deeply within something.

****entrench****

= establish so firmly that changing/removing it becomes difficult.

> values embedded in culture

> practices entrenched in bureaucracy

****Embed**** does not inherently imply resistance to change as strongly.

****entrench vs institutionalize****

****institutionalize****

= make something part of formal/established institutional practice.

****entrench****

= make it difficult to remove/change.

Institutionalization can produce entrenchment, but they are not identical.

entrench vs normalize

normalize

= make something seem normal/ordinary/accepted.

entrench

= make it durable and difficult to reverse.

This connects directly to your passage:

- > normalize restaurant tutoring
- > could eventually
- > entrench the underlying arrangement/problem.

entrench vs cement

Figuratively:

cement

= strengthen/make firm.

entrench

= make especially resistant to removal/change.

- > cement a relationship
- > entrench a power structure

Collocations differ substantially.

entrench vs consolidate

consolidate

= strengthen/combine a position or gain.

entrench

= secure it against displacement/change.

- > consolidate one's position
- > entrench oneself in power

Close in power/business contexts.

entrench vs lock in

lock in

= create conditions making later change costly/difficult.

entrench

= establish deeply enough that change becomes difficult.

Very close in:

- * technology
- * institutions
- * policy systems.

Lock-in often emphasizes switching costs/path dependence; **entrench** emphasizes firmness/resistance.

entrench vs ossify

ossify

figuratively = become rigid and unable to adapt.

entrench

= become firmly established.

An entrenched institution is difficult to change; an ossified institution additionally suggests:

- > rigidity and loss of adaptability.

entrench vs root

deeply rooted

= deeply established because of long history/origins.

deeply entrenched

= strongly established and resistant to change.

Very close.

Entrenched has stronger defensive/resistance imagery.

entrench vs ingrained

ingrained

especially habits, beliefs, attitudes:
deeply fixed in someone's behaviour/thinking.

entrenched

works more broadly for:
systems, institutions, power, inequality, practices.

> ingrained habit
> entrenched bureaucracy

Overlap for beliefs/attitudes.

entrenched vs embedded

entrenched

= hard to change.

embedded

= deeply incorporated.

Something can be embedded without being actively resistant to reform.

entrenched vs endemic

endemic

= regularly/native/persistently present in a place/population/domain.

entrenched

= structurally firmly established and resistant to change.

Do not treat them as synonyms.

entrenched vs chronic

chronic

= continuing for a long time.

entrenched

= long-standing **and difficult to alter because it is firmly established**.

A chronic problem may not necessarily be structurally entrenched.

entrenched interests vs vested interests

As above:

* vested = have something to gain/lose

* entrenched = securely established and resistant to displacement.

entrenched position — literal vs figurative

Literal

fortified military position.

Figurative

firmly held stance.

Context decides.

AA. GRAMMAR

95. **entrench + direct object**

> entrench a practice

> entrench inequality

> entrench power

> entrench rights

Meaning:

> make X firmly established.

96. **entrench oneself**

> "The organization entrenched itself in the market."

Reflexive construction:

> secure one's own position.

97. **be entrenched in + system/place**

Very common:

> entrenched in society

> entrenched in the organization

> entrenched in law

> entrenched in tradition

98. **be entrenched within + system**

More formal:

> “The practice is entrenched within the institution.”

99. ****be deeply/firmly entrenched****

Often no prepositional phrase is needed:

> “The problem is deeply entrenched.”

100. ****entrench X as Y****

Possible:

> “The change entrenched the company as the leading supplier.”

Meaning:

> made its position as Y secure.

Less central than ****entrench X in****.

101. ****entrench on/upon — rare****

Historical structure:

> entrench upon someone's rights

= encroach/infringe.

Do ****not**** apply this old construction to normal modern figurative ****entrench****.

AB. COUNTABILITY

****entrenchment — process/state****

Usually uncountable:

- > managerial entrenchment
- > constitutional entrenchment
- > institutional entrenchment

an entrenchment — military fortification

Can be countable in the literal military sense:

- > an entrenchment
- > several entrenchments

entrenched

Adjective/participle; no countability issue.

AC. FAMILY MAP

Family member	Main modern meanings
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entrench — literal military	surround/strengthen a position with trenches
entrench — figurative	make a belief, practice, system, problem, power, etc. firmly established and hard to change
entrench oneself	secure one's own institutional, market, or power position
entrench — legal	give rights/rules/provisions enhanced protection against ordinary alteration
entrench — geomorphology	cut a channel downward deeply through erosion
entrenched — adjective	deeply established and resistant to change; or literally fortified by trenches
entrenchment	process/state of becoming firmly established; military fortification; several specialist academic meanings
intrench	uncommon variant spelling
entrench on/upon	archaic/rare: encroach upon/infringe

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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entrench — military	挖掘壕溝來鞏固、防守某陣地
entrench oneself — military	掘壕固守
entrenched position — military	有壕溝 / 防禦工事保護的堅固陣地
entrenchment — military	築壕設防的過程；亦可指壕溝防禦工事
entrenching tool	軍用掘壕鏟 / 挖掘防禦工事的工具
entrench — general figurative	使某事變得牢固確立、根深蒂固而難以改變
deeply entrenched	已根深蒂固、非常難改變
entrenched belief/attitude	難以改變的根深蒂固信念 / 態度
entrenched habit/practice	長期形成並難以改變的習慣 / 做法
entrenched system	因長期建立而難以改革 / 取代的制度
entrench a problem	令問題更長期、結構化、難以解決
entrenched structural problem	已深深植根於制度 / 社會安排中的結構性問題
entrench inequality/disadvantage	令不平等 / 弱勢狀況固化並更難改變
entrench poverty	令貧困狀況長期化、難以脫離
entrench power/control	使權力 / 控制地位更牢固、難以挑戰
entrench oneself in power	鞏固自己的權力地位，使自己難以被取代
entrench oneself in a market	在市場建立牢固而難以撼動的位置
entrenched incumbent	已佔穩位置、難以被新競爭者取代的現任者 / 既有供應商
entrenched interests	根基牢固並有能力抵抗改變的既得利益
entrenched position — figurative	固守而難以改變的立場
entrenched technology/system	因廣泛既有使用而難以被替換的技術 / 系統
entrench rights/rules	給權利 / 規則更強的制度性保障，使之較難修改
constitutional entrenchment	令憲制規範比普通法律更難修改的制度安排
entrenched provision	受到較高修訂門檻保護的條文
provision for entrenchment — company law	在公司章程中提高特定條文修訂 / 廢除門檻的安排
managerial entrenchment	管理層令自己更難被替換或受到治理機制約束的狀態
entrenchment index	公司治理研究中衡量某些管理層固守因素的專門指標
linguistic entrenchment	語言形式因反覆使用 / 接觸而在認知表徵中逐漸固化
river/channel entrenchment	河流向下侵蝕，使河道深切於原地面 / 泛濫平原
entrenched meander	深切進地形中的曲流
entrench on/upon — old	侵犯 / 侵佔某人的權利或領域；罕見舊義
intrench	entrench 的少見變體拼法

For your original sentence

> "...it relieves pressure for a few individuals but **entrenches the larger structural problem** for everyone else."

The exact meaning is:

**entrenches = 這種臨時安排雖然暫時幫到部分學生，卻令「香港缺乏足夠合適學習空間」這個根本問題繼續被制度吸收和容忍，因而變得更固定、更長期、更難真正解決。 **

So the best Chinese is not merely:

> 「使問題惡化」

because **worsen/exacerbate** focuses on severity.

The stronger idea is:

> **「使這個結構性問題根深蒂固 / 固化，使日後更難改革。」 **

There is a useful semantic sequence in the paragraph:

- > restaurants temporarily **fill the gap**
- > → immediate pressure is reduced
- > → proper institutions feel less pressure to **expand** study provision
- > → the underlying shortage continues
- > → the shortage becomes **entrenched**

So **entrench** specifically captures **structural persistence**.

For the core database, I would keep **5 principal branches**:

1. **literal military — fortify by digging trenches**
2. **figurative — make an idea, habit, practice, system, problem, or condition firmly established and hard to change**
3. **secure oneself, one's power, position, or advantage against displacement**
4. **legal/constitutional — give a rule, right, or provision enhanced protection from ordinary amendment**
5. **geomorphology — cut a river/channel deeply downward through erosion**

Then separately index **entrenched interests, managerial entrenchment, linguistic entrenchment, entrenched meanders, entrenchment clauses**, and the rare **entrench on/upon = encroach/infringe**, because those are genuine established extensions that would otherwise disappear under the generic translation 「使根深蒂固」.

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